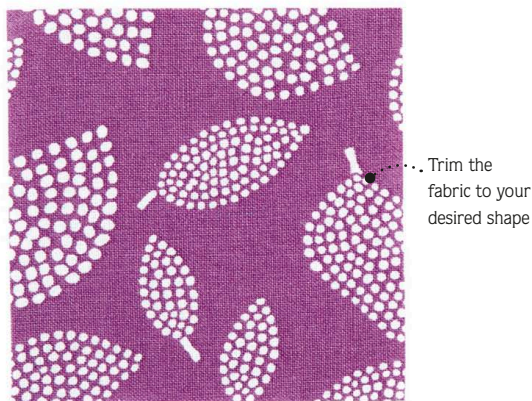


▶ FRAYED-EDGE APPLIQUÉ

The edges of appliquéd pieces need not always be neatly finished. Leaving the edges frayed gives a casual and worn look to an appliquéd piece. This technique works well on items for kids. You can add

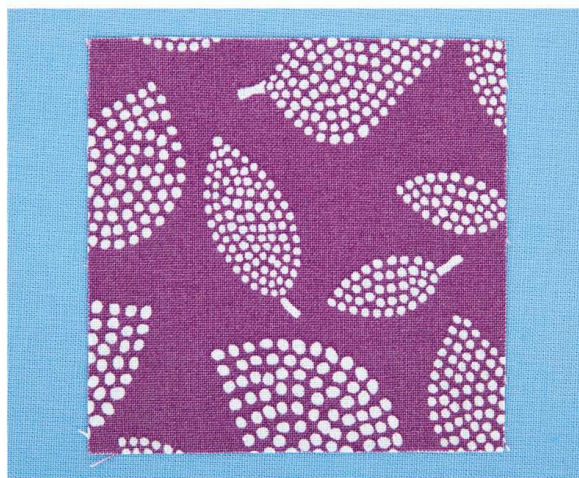
interfacing to the back of the appliqué piece, just inside the seam allowance, to give it more stability and to keep the edges from fraying back too far and the shape from becoming detached.



1 Cut out the shape you wish to attach to your main fabric adding a 1 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) seam allowance all around. If you'd like to interface the shape to give it more stability, cut a piece of interfacing the same size as the shape, without the seam allowance and apply it to the wrong side of the shape.



2 Using a fabric glue stick designed for appliqué, lightly apply glue to the wrong side of the shape. If you are not using a fabric glue stick, skip to Step 3.



3 Position the shape in place on the right side of the background fabric. If you used glue, go to Step 4. If not, pin or tack the shape in place.



4 Using your sewing machine or a needle and thread, stitch through both layers inside the edge of the appliqué shape leaving a 1 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) seam allowance. Remove any pins or tacking stitches. The edges will fray over time, but to speed up the process you can put the finished item through a normal wash and dry cycle, to roughen up the free edges.